POLE STARS

Yogi Adityanath reigns supreme in the minds of respondents across India; Naveen Patnaik cements his place at the top among CMs with highest ratings at home

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Of the 30 states in India, including Delhi and Puducherry, 14 are ruled by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), either on its own or in an alliance. It, therefore, comes as no surprise that in the latest INDIA TODAY-CVoter Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll, six of the 10 chief ministers with the highest satisfaction ratings in their home states belong to the BJP. Yet, neither the BJP nor its traditional rival Congress, which rules in three states and is a junior partner in another, could bag the top two positions. The first spot went to Odisha CM Naveen Patnaik, who heads the regional party Biju Janata Dal. He is followed by Delhi CM and Aam Aadmi Party supremo Arvind Kejriwal, who has clocked a massive jump in popularity within the state, with 69.2 per cent respondents expressing satisfaction with his performance, up from 58.9 per cent in August 2022.

Patnaik's run at the top, on the other hand, continues with a marginal drop—from 78.1 per cent six months ago to 73.2 per cent in the latest poll. But what makes this high approval rating extraordinary is the fact that Odisha's longest-

Q MOST POPULAR CM (ACROSS INDIA)

All respondents were asked who they think is the best performing CM in India

1 YOGI ADITYANATH *Uttar Pradesh* **39.1%** [39.8%]

2 **ARVIND KEJRIWAL** *Delhi* **16%** [22.3%]

3 **MAMATA BANERJEE** *West Bengal* **7.3%** [8.8%]

4 **M.K. STALIN** *Tamil Nadu* **4.6%** [5.3%]

5 **NAVEEN PATNAIK** *Odisha* **3.4%** [3.6%]

6 **HIMANTA BISWA SARMA** *Assam* **2.5%** [2.3%]

7 **SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN** *Madhya Pradesh* **2.4%** [1.4%]

8 **EKNATH SHINDE** *Maharashtra* **2.2%** [0.2%]

9 **Y.S. JAGAN MOHAN REDDY** *Andhra Pradesh* **1.6%** [3.9%]

10 **BHUPESH BAGHEL** *Chhattisgarh* **1.4%** [1.4%]

Rest others, Don't know/ Can't say; Jan. 2023 figs in bold; Aug. 2022 in brackets
The ratings are the perception of all respondents across India. So, 39.1 per cent of the 105,008 respondents rated Yogi Adityanath as the No. 1 chief minister in India